

THE FRANK ANTHONY MEMORIAL ALL INDIA INTER-SCHOOL DEBATE COMPETITION
2026 (CATEGORY I & II)

RULES

Participants This Debate will be conducted in two categories: **Category I** for students of **Classes XI & XII** and **Category II** for students of **Class IX & X**.

Teams: Each team should comprise of two speakers – one for the motion and one against the motion. It is not essential that the same two participants represent the school in the different stages of the Debate. The selection of the team is left to the discretion of the school. However, the participants should be bona fide students (on rolls) of the school and class certified by the head of the school as on the date of each stage of the Debate.

Participants are to produce the School ID card at the time of registration. In case there is no identity card, the Principal/Head of the School may send a letter on the school letter-head indicating the participant's entry.

The participants are **not** to wear their school uniform, they are to be dressed in formal wear.

Names of participating schools should **not** be displayed. However, they can be termed as Team "A", "B", "C" etc.

Entry The Debate in both categories is conducted in three stages.

Stage I - Preliminary Stage

The participating schools have been grouped into different pools.

The **winning team** and the **first runner-up team** will qualify for Stage II (Selection stage) automatically. PLEASE ANNOUNCE THE NAME OF WINNING SCHOOL AND FIRST RUNNER-UP SCHOOL AT THE END OF THE COMPETITION

Stage II - Selection Stage

All Stage I (Preliminary stage) winners (i.e., the winning teams and the first runner-up teams) will move on to Stage II (Selection stage) automatically.

Stage III - Semi Finals

All Stage II (Selection stage) winners (i.e., the winning team and the first runner-up teams) will move on to Stage III (Semi Finals) automatically.

Stage IV - National Finals

The winning team from each pool of the Semi-Finals will go on to debate at the National Finals.

Debate Format

The topic for the Debate will be sent to the host school in a sealed envelope. This envelope will be opened only on the day of the competition in the presence of the participants.

They will be given the topic for debate **one hour before** the commencement of the Debate.

This one hour is to be spent in preparation. Once the topic has been declared, no participant coming late will be allowed to participate in the Debate. No teacher or escort will be present with the participants at this time and no attempt should be made to assist them in any way.

The participants may be accommodated in the school library and may have access to books and journals for preparation. **The use of internet/any electronic gadgets during preparation time is not permitted.**

Speakers will not be allowed to read out from prepared texts and if found reading out from a paper he/she will be penalized by the Judges appropriately. **This will be announced by the Moderator at the start of the Debate.** It is left to each school team to decide who will speak for the proposition and who will speak for the opposition. **Participants should desist from using un-parliamentary language during the debate competition.**

Each speaker will be given **four minutes** to speak. A bell will be rung at the end of three minutes to indicate that only one more minute is left for the speaker to wind up his/her debate. Another bell will be rung at the end of four minutes.

After every speaker finishes his/her debate, two minutes will be allotted for Rebuttal. This rebuttal will be in the form of short and precise questions asked by the members of the competing teams on the content of the speaker's presentation. Judges will give marks to the speaker out of 10 on how well he/she answers. In case, no question is asked within ten seconds, the chairperson will remind the competitors that if no question is asked within the next ten seconds, then the judges will give full marks for Rebuttal to the speaker.

The judges will use the following scoring format:-

1. Content	15 marks
2. Argument/Rebuttal	10 marks
3. Appropriateness of Language	10 marks
4. Delivery	10 marks
5. Demeanor/Poise/Stance	5 marks

The Debate in each Pool will be judged by a panel of three judges. The results will be compiled in the following manner:-

i) Each judge will award marks to each speaker. **The raw marks awarded to each participant has to be totalled (in the TOTAL column) and the positions have to be awarded accordingly (in the POSITION column) of the Judge's Score Sheet.**

ii) On the Judge's Score-Sheet, the speakers will be awarded **positions (ranked)** according to their totals.

iii) The Tabulator will record, in the Tabulation Sheet, **only the "POSITIONS" that each judge awards** to each speaker and **NOT** the raw marks. Thus, the speaker with the lowest total (in the Tabulation Sheet) will be declared the best speaker of the Pool and the team with the lowest total (in the Tabulation Sheet) will be the winner of the Pool.

PLEASE REFER TO THE SPECIMEN TABULATION SHEET ON PAGE 4.

iv) If there is a tie, the **tie is to be broken** in all cases whether Best Speaker/1st runner up speaker/2nd runner-up speaker/best team/runner-up team, the following method will be used to break the tie:

1. The two candidates who have tied, the lowest rank that each of them has received will be eliminated and the total of the two higher ranks will be used to break the tie. Thus the one with the lower rank total wins. From the specimen tabulation sheet below, candidate BBB and JJJ have tied. Thus to break this tie, rank 3 of BBB will be eliminated and rank 2 of JJJ will be eliminated. **Thus the totals of their two higher scores, candidate BBB will be $1+1 = 2$ and JJJ will be $2+1=3$, thus BBB is the winner.**

S.No.	Name of School	Name of Speaker	Judge 1	Judge 2	Judge 3	Total	Rank/Positio
			RAW SCORES				
1.	PPPPPPPPPP	1. BBBB BBBB B	3	1	1	5	1
2.	QQQQQQQQQQ	2. JJJJJJJJJJJJ	2	2	1	5	1

2. If there is still a tie after the above method is used, the lowest raw score (of the 3 judges) of each of the candidates who have tied will be deleted and only the first and second raw score total will be considered to break the tie. Thus the candidate with the higher raw score total will be the winner. From the specimen tabulation sheet, below, candidate BBB will have his lowest score of 37 eliminated and candidate JJJ will have his lowest score of 36 eliminated. **Thus candidate JJJ wins with the highest score of 80.**

S.No.	Name of School	Name of Speaker	Judge 1	Judge 2	Judge 3	Total of raw scores	Total of the 2 higher raw scores
			RAW SCORES				
1.	PPPPPPPPPP	1. BBBB BBBB B	39	40	37	116	79
2.	QQQQQQQQQQ	2. JJJJJJJJJJJJJJ	40	36	40	116	80

TA/DA: All travel, accommodation/lodging and incidental expenses incurred by the participating teams will be borne by the participating schools concerned.

SPECIMEN TABULATION SHEET

S.No.	Name of School	Name of Speaker		Judge 1	Judge 2	Judge 3	Total	Position	Team Total
				P O S I T I O N S					
1.	PPPPPPPPPP	1.	AAAAAAAAAAAAAA	5	7	6	18	8	23
		2.	BBBBBBBBBBBBBBB	3	1	1	5	1	
2.	QQQQQQQQQQQ	3.	CCCCCCCCCCCCC	5	5	5	15	6	34
		4.	DDDDDDDDDDDDDD	7	8	4	19	9	
3.	RRRRRRRRRRR	5.	EEEEEEEEEEEEEEE	6	8	6	20	10	38
		6.	FFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFF	5	6	7	18	7	
4.	SSSSSSSSSSSSS	7.	GGGGGGGGGGGGG	1	3	3	7	3	16
		8.	HHHHHHHHHHHHH	2	3	4	9	4	
5.	TTTTTTTTTTTTT	9.	IIIIIIIIIIIIIII	4	4	4	12	5	18
		10.	JJJJJJJJJJJJJJ	2	2	2	6	2	

BEST SPEAKER: BBBBBBBBBBBBBB	TABULATOR: SIGNATURE: DATE:
1ST RUNNER-UP SPEAKER: JJJJJJJJJJJJJJ	
2ND RUNNER-UP SPEAKER: GGGGGGGGGGGG	
WINNING TEAM: SSSSSSSSSSSS	